3. Dictatorship of the Cabinet When the ruling party enjoys absolute majority in the Parliament, the cabinet becomes autocratic and exercises nearly unlimited powers. H.J. Laski says that the parliamentary system gives the executive an opportunity for tyranny. Ramsay Muir, the British historian, also complained of the 'dictatorship of the cabinet'[2]. This phenomenon was witnessed during the era of Indira Gandhi and Rajiv Gandhi.

4. Against Separation of Powers In the parliamentary system, the legislature and the executive are together and inseparable. The cabinet acts as the leader of legislature as well as the executive. As Bagehot points out, 'the cabinet is a hyphen that joins the buckle that binds the executive and legislative departments together.' Hence, the whole system of government goes against the letter and spirit of the theory of separation of powers[3]. In fact, there is a fusion of powers.

5. Government by Amateurs The parliamentary system is not conducive to administrative efficiency as the ministers are not experts in their fields. The Prime Minister has a limited choice in the selection of ministers; his/her choice is restricted to the members of Parliament alone and does not extend to external talent. Moreover, the ministers devote most of their time to parliamentary work, cabinet meetings and party activities.

The comparison of the parliamentary and presidential systems in terms of their features, merits and demerits is given in Table 13.1.

REASONS FOR ADOPTING PARLIAMENTARY SYSTEM

A plea was made in favour of the US presidential system of government in the Constituent Assembly[4]. But, the founding fathers preferred the British parliamentary system due to the following reasons:

1. Familiarity with the System The Constitution-makers were somewhat familiar with the parliamentary system as it had been in operation in India during the British rule. K.M. Munshi argued that, 'For the last thirty or forty years, some kind of responsibility has been introduced in the governance of this country. Our constitutional traditions have become Parliamentary. After this experience, why should we go back and buy a novel experience.'[5]

2. Preference to More Responsibility Dr. B.R. Ambedkar pointed out in the Constituent Assembly that 'a democratic executive must satisfy two conditions: stability and responsibility. Unfortunately, it has not been possible so far to devise a system which can ensure both in equal degree. The American system gives more stability but less responsibility. The British system, on the other hand, gives more responsibility but less stability. The Draft Constitution in recommending the parliamentary system of Executive has preferred more responsibility to more stability.'[6]

Table 13.1 Comparing Parliamentary and Presidential Systems

Parliamentary System	Presidential System
Features: 1. Dual executive. 2. Majority party rule	Features: 1. Single executive.